UK Data Service

Making secure qualitative data available via TREs

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The value of qualitative data

ESRC £1 million grant to fund research into migration crisis

September 18, 2015 by alessiodangelo | Leave a comment

In response to the on-going migration crisis the ESRC is providing £1 million to support leading UK social scientists to conduct research with migrant and refugee populations who have entered Europe across the Mediterranean.

Eight projects from across the UK are being funded under the ESRC's Urgency Grants Mechanism. This is the first time the ESRC has activated this funding mechanism on a strategic basis, in response to a crisis.

Co-funded by the Department for International Development, the Mediterranean Migration Research Programme, which goes live today, will provide evidence to inform the development of policy and responses by governments, European agencies, and charities.

For further information visit the ESRC website:
http://www.esrc.ac.uk/news-events-and-publications/news/news-items/1-million-urgency-grant-to-fund-social-science-research-into-migration-crisis/

Recommendations from seminar

- 3-prongs: consent, access, and anonymisation
- Review and feedback on DMPs (pre-data collection)
  - Accept wider range of data formats
  - Ensuring resources allocated to data cleaning

Archive’s concerns over qualitative data

- Some offerings we were not able to accept because of concerns over level of detail and/or lack of consent/information provided to participants on archiving
  - Women in Conflict Archive
  - Centre for Family Research

Why?

- Social, political and historical context of the data may make anonymisation undesirable (or even impossible)
- Availability of other datasets may raise of the risk of disclosure
- There may not be a viable plan to mitigate effects in the event of a disclosure – this particularly applies where there is fears of reprisals and/or personal safety of participants
- Anonymisation strategies may adversely affect the value of the data, and lack of standardised way of documenting changes may affect understanding
- High profile data may require ability to restrict access where this generates a lot of attention from a broader range of people – may testslimits of access restriction

Current work arounds: Access restriction

Affluent Worker in the Class Structure, 1961-1962

https://beta.ukdataservice.ac.uk/datacatalogue/studies/study?id=7944#!/details

Affluent Worker in the Class Structure, 1961-1962: Special Licence Access

Details | Documentation | Resources | Access data

Access data

The Data Collection is available to UK Data Service registered users subject to the End User Licence Agreement.

Use of the data requires approval from the data owner or their nominee.

⚠ This study is currently embargoed and therefore unavailable for download/order.

Current work arounds: Withholding some (not all) data

Health and Social Consequences of the 2001 Foot and Mouth Disease Epidemic

https://beta.ukdataservice.ac.uk/datacatalogue/studies/study?id=5407

Interviews (audio and transcript) and written diaries with 54 people

- 40 interview and diary transcripts are archived and available for re-use by registered users
- 3 interviews and 5 diaries were embargoed until 2015
- Audio files archived and only available by permission from researchers

Current work arounds: Data summary

Unravelling the Mediterranean migration crisis: The MEDMIG project journey data

https://beta.ukdataservice.ac.uk/datacatalogue/studies/study?id=852674#!/details

Interview name	Gender	Age range	Nationality	Ethnicity	Country of origin	Marital status	Children	Education level	Employment or Education status before journey
Int001	F	30-39	Stateless	Palestinian	Syria	Widowed	2	Secondary	Employed
Int002	M	18-29	Syria	Syria	Syria	Single	0	University	Employed
Int003	M	30-39	Syria	Kurdish	Syria	Married	1	Secondary	Employed
Int004	F	18-29	Afghanistan	Pushtan	Afghanistan	SIngle	0	none	Unemployed
Int005	M	50-59	Syria	Syria	Syria	Married	7	University (postgrad)	Employed
Int006	M	50-59	Afghanistan	Hazara	Iran	Divorced/Seperated	0	University	Employed
Int007	M	80+	Syria	Palestinian	Syria	Widowed	2	none	Employed

Current work arounds: Interview summaries

Pioneers of Social Research

https://beta.ukdataservice.ac.uk/datacatalogue/studies/study?id=6226

1. Sara Arber

Biography

Sara Arber is a sociologist who has played an influential role in developing standards of survey practice and analysis through her publications (*Doing Secondary Analysis,* 1988) and through her teaching and research practice based at Surrey University.

Future plan at UKDS

- Looking at a specific case study – e.g. interviews with care homes, which includes health data of a vulnerable group
- Harnessing machine-learning to identify potentially disclosive information – knit this into ingest/output checking
  - May help to reduce human error and makes process more efficient
  - Would need to be used in conjunction with manual checks
  - Needs parameters to work with – what information tends to be most disclosive and at what level? To what extent can tools be modified to the needs of the dataset?
- Outline procedures for output checking (or similar processes) for secure quali
  - Considerations needed for how to balance resource requirements
  - Considerations needed for when/how much to anonymise
- Potential application to mixed methods/open text in surveys as well

What do outputs of qualidata look like?

Often the focus is on the level of detail within text or images, but what do researchers do with this data?

- Quotes and/or profiles
- Themes
- Vignettes
- Visualisations
- Quantification
- “Fake” case studies
- “Meta” analysis strategies – not talking about individuals but larger political and social movements

How do P.I.s maintain confidentiality, and what guidance can we give re-users to similarly follow this trend?

Text outputs: Quotations and anecdotes

Pharmacist: We will soon be starting a stop smoking clinic.

Patient: Is the interview over now?

Pharmacist: No this is part of it. (Laughs) You can't tell me to bog off (sic) yet. (pause) We will be starting a stop smoking service here,

Patient: Yes.

Pharmacist: with one-to-one and we will be able to help you or try to help you. If you want it.

In this example, the pharmacist has picked up from the patient's reaction to the stop smoking clinic that she is not receptive to advice about giving up smoking at this time; in fact she would rather end the consultation. The pharmacist draws on his prior relationship with the patient and makes use of a joke to lighten the tone. He feels his message is important enough to persevere but he presents the information in a succinct and non-pressurised way. His final comment of “If you want it” is important as this makes it clear that he is not putting any pressure on the patient to take up this offer. This extract shows that some patient cues were picked up, and appropriately dealt with, but this was not the case in all examples.

Citation: Kurtz S and Silverman J. (1996). The Calgary-Cambridge referenced observation guides: an aid to defining the curriculum and organizing the teaching in communication training programmes. *Med Educ.* 30, pp. 83–89.

Visual outputs: Conceptual models

Table 1. Parent and child control of children's foods: Distribution of cases (N = 47).

Strong	**A: Hierarchical** 1. **Overt** (14 cases) 2. **Covert** (7 cases)	**B: Resistance** (1 case)	
Parental control	**D: Negotiated order** (13 cases)	**C: Child control** (12 cases)	
Weak	Child control		Strong

Citation: O'Connell, R., & Brannen, J. (2014). Children's food, power and control: Negotiations in families with younger children in England. *Childhood: A Global Journal of Child Research, 21*(1), 87–102. https://doi.org/10.1177/0907568213476900

Visual outputs: Diagramming

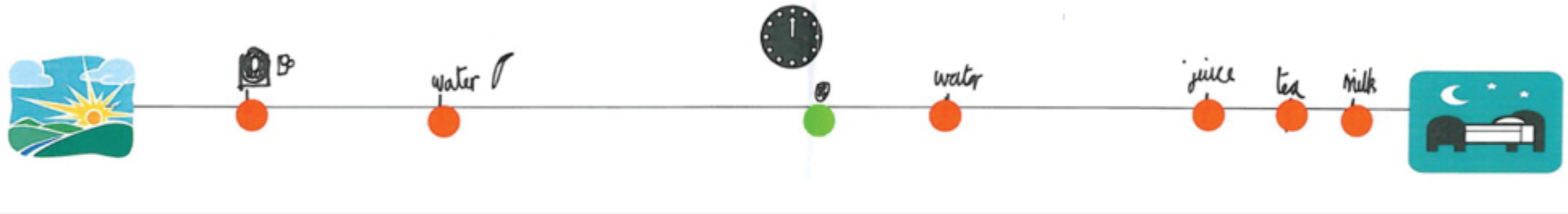

Figure 3. Amelia's weekday.

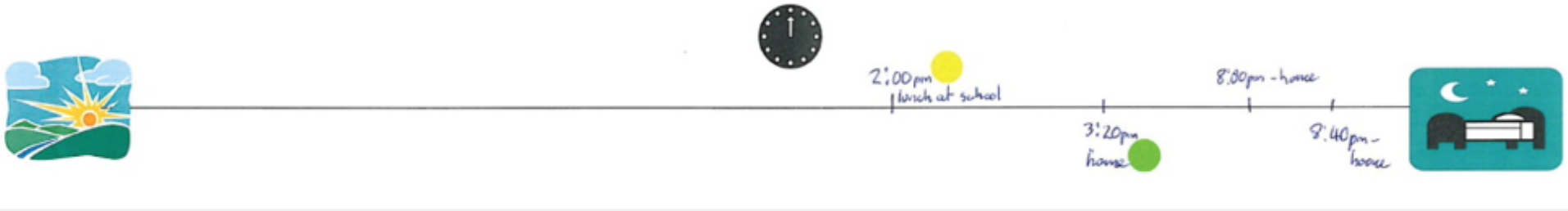

Figure 4. Jade's time-line.

Citation: O'Connell, R., & Brannen, J. (2014). Children's food, power and control: Negotiations in families with younger children in England. *Childhood: A Global Journal of Child Research, 21*(1), 87–102. https://doi.org/10.1177/0907568213476900

Text outputs: Themes

What a daddy is

All of the children, except one, brought up daddies during their interviews. Most of the ch

Not having a daddy

None of the children included a father (or donor) in the drawings of their own families. Some of them also spontaneously told the interviewer that they don't have a daddy. This

Men, seed daddies and daddies in the children's own conception

When asked about their own conception, most of the children were tentative at first, but everyone eventually said or confirmed that they come from one of their mummies' tum-

Citation: Malmquist, A., Möllerstrand, A., Wikström, M., & Nelson, K. Z. (2014). 'A daddy is the same as a mummy': Swedish children in lesbian households talk about fathers and donors. *Childhood: A Global Journal of Child Research, 21*(1), 119–133. https://doi.org/10.1177/0907568213484342

Text outputs: Profiles or case studies

resting-place for the individual engaged in the perpetual human task of keeping inner and outer reality separate yet interrelated.

(Winnicott, 1971[2005], p.3, original emphasis)

Jenny in her milieu: Vignettes from a year, written from observation notes

Jenny is straightening her hair in front of the mirror in the sitting room when the observer arrives for the first time. The baby is asleep in a swing cradle, which takes up a large space in an already crowded room. A computer is on the table showing a card game. Several posters of Bob Marley are pinned on the wall, along with a Rastafari poem. Photos of the family are on the mantelpiece: Jenny with her next brother; her twin younger brothers; her parents looking proudly at the newborn baby. Jenny has a part-time job at a telesales company, selling kitchens on commission, and she is getting ready to go out. She tells the observer that it is boring, that she feels sorry for the people she phones up, especially if they are elderly and haven't got the thought of a new kitchen, with all the upheaval involved. She laughs, 'I want to tell them it's okay and not to worry.' She explains that it is helpful living at home because of all the help she gets. A sound of keys in the front door announces her parents, accompanied by the rustling of shopping bags. Her father comes in and Jenny explains the observer's presence. He introduces himself and looks at the baby for a moment. He leaves the room and there is the sound of cupboards opening and closing as shopping is put away. The baby stirs. Jenny picks him up gently and explains that she will feed him before she goes out but that she is part bottle feeding him, so that others can feed him when she is at work or at college.

The following week, the observer's visit is early in the day and everyone is at home. The observer enters the sitting room to greet Jenny's father who is sitting on the sofa in his pyjamas holding Davy. He says something to Jenny and hands over the baby gently, who lies comfortably, as if about to fall asleep, sucking rhythmically on his dummy. A few minutes later, Julian [the baby's father] comes in and greets the observer in a friendly way – their first meeting. Jenny says she needs to get ready and hands over Davy to his father. Davy settles into Julian's arm and after a while begins to grimace and squirm a little. Julian explains that he is constipated and it hurts him. He says to him softly 'oh there, it's alright man' and rocks him, murmuring from time to time. He holds Davy's hand, letting the baby curl his fingers around one of his own and caresses his forehead. When he holds him up to his shoulder, Davy

sses wind. When the observer comments on his ease with the baby, ian says he is the second eldest of seven children. He agrees wryly h the observer that this makes him quite experienced. Davy starts ting into Julian's chest and he comments that he doesn't know when ny last fed him. But he settles Davy again and takes him to their droom to put him down.

The week after – later in the day – the observer arrives to see Julian ozing in the armchair with Davy lying back against his chest, the looking utterly relaxed and comfortable. Jenny is sitting at the computer, typing. After a while Davy stirs and stretches and Julian follows t. He talks to Jenny who is helping him with one of his assignments. vy, having fallen asleep again, now starts to whimper and Julian says Jenny that he is probably hungry. Jenny looks at the clock and comments that he'll also need his medicine. Julian holds him while Jenny s to the kitchen and returns with a bottle of milk and a syringe full of dicine. He continues while Jenny gives the medicine and then hands n over to Jenny and they comment on how he likes sweet things. vy drinks the whole bottle lustily, while Julian takes over the computer. She tells the observer that she has given up the telesales job – it's far and she hardly saw Julian.

When Davy is 12 weeks old and it is still the summer vacation, Jenny ooking for a job again, combing the local paper, bemoaning the fact t the paper is full of telesales jobs and nothing else and how she es trying to sell to people things that they do not want. She seems d. Her father comes in and starts playing with the baby, speaking a singsong voice. Davy babbles in a lively way. He pulls himself up ngly, holding his grandfather's hands, looking delighted. The two y contentedly for most of the observation, only interrupted when ny changes Davy's nappy.

The following week, the observer arrives to find that Jenny is out having a driving lesson. Grandfather is in charge and both twins are in the ing room, one playing a computer game, and the other playing with vy, who is in his chair. After a while he begins to whimper. Grandfather is watching a film on TV. He goes out and, as Davy begins to grizzle, urns with Davy's bottle, testing the temperature on his arm. Too hot, it five minutes. The boy tries to distract Davy and waits. When the minutes is up, he takes Davy out of his chair and settles himself the sofa holding Davy gently but confidently on the crook of his n. Grandfather returns to test the milk and give the go-ahead. Davy ds heartily, gulping the milk, until it is almost finished. He arches his k, as if feeling wind. The boy tries offering him the last bit and when

jected, he puts the bottle down and sits Davy up. Rhythmically s his back until, after about five minutes, Davy gives a satisfying The boy then smells his nappy and takes Davy through to the bed- He talks to Davy a little, and Davy's face breaks into a smile as the eans him up.

he end of November, when Davy is seven months old, Jenny is at the computer again while Davy sleeps on the sofa surrounded hions so that he doesn't roll off. She is working on a 2000-word due in, along with a project, at the end of the week. She feels a essed. Not only college, she has found a good retail job and works me three days a week. After a while, Davy stretches and rubs his wisting his head around in the direction of Jenny. She immedimiles and says hello and he begins to make some sounds. She gets d comes over and Davy tries to turn to reach for her, moving on front and getting into a crawling position, but only managing to backwards. When she holds out her hands, he grabs them and himself up, smiling and happy. He bounces vigorously on the sofa. epeat the game. After a while, when Davy runs out of steam and king expectantly at noises from the kitchen, Jenny looks at the Almost immediately, her father arrives with Davy's lunch – veg- and rice. Davy looks excitedly at him and waves his arms. Once chair, he eagerly accepts each mouthful, only gradually towards d of the bowl letting it ooze out of his mouth. Jenny leaves what and wipes him up quietly, lifting him out when he raises his arms. the eve of Davy's first birthday, Jenny and Julian have the evening er and are reminiscing about their year. On the way to the hospilian was meant to go into the shop to get some phone credit and s waiting in the taxi. He came back with Kentucky Fried chicken d and then he's asking her if she wants hot wings in the lift inside spital and she's like 'no I don't want any hot wings'.

y reflects on her year with interviewer and observer. Julian comes every day, guaranteed. She doesn't even have to ask him what e doing. They were already spending a lot of time together before t pregnant; that's not changed, but perhaps it's made them closer thing. Often, it's just the three of them, in the house, chilling uite happy, no major problems or anything. A lot of her friends stick around, which is what she expected, but the important ones ll in touch. Davy recognises them. He's very sociable. He knows s brothers and Julian's family too, and says mama and dada.

y had to give up college after Davy was ill and in hospital for a She didn't want to get bad grades and so will return next year.

lian continued. She doesn't go out much now, but she celebrated her ghteenth birthday with some friends and got drunk for the first time ages. But even proper drunk, she was thinking, I've got a baby at ome, make sure I go home alright. She can still have fun and look after avy. Her parents remained strict after Davy was born, but now they ave nothing to discipline her about, so it's been alright. They know at if she's out late with Davy she'll only be at Julian's house. She's ere loads. She talks to his Mum, also his brothers and sisters. They ten go to the park together. Things are better with her Mum, in fact er Mum's happier than she used to be. They don't have anything to gue about any more. Mum will buy the nappies, and Dad buys the ilk. It's made everyone closer. It's just been a good experience. She's ot ready to move out yet.

She's thought about it a lot and reckons that it's a good time to have baby when you're a teenager because you get lots of help. If you were grown up woman, people would think you could just get on with it your own. There's less time for herself, but she's got used to that. It's ade her more patient. One thing she's noticed is how now she can't ar to see a child being hurt or in difficulty.

I discuss later (Chapter 6) the changes to my style of distilling and esenting data for the purposes of sharing information with readers d also how I work to 'know' the data. Here I will just comment that reat the above information as a form of 'scenic' experiencing accruing to a kind of holistic knowing that may never be articulated through nguage. Thus the reader gets a different quality of access to Jenny in er setting.

acing reality

llowing reflective principles, after I had listened to each of Jenny's ree interviews, I asked myself how I responded to Jenny, whom I never et face to face. (This was a feature of the early data analysis for each rticipant.) My note starts 'I like Jenny, right from the beginning (…). e FACES REALITY, even though reality is difficult for her'. In the note, go on to list some of the details that impressed me. They amount to hat seems to me an unusual strength of character, or perhaps emonal maturity, for her age and in her situation: her efforts to continue ith her studies (but the decision to postpone them when they contct too much with Davy's care after he is hospitalised), her handling her boyfriend Julian's initial opposition to her continuing the pregncy, her approach to the lack of financial resources and the scarcity of

Citation: Hollway, W. (2015). The Reality of Being a Young Mother: Agency, Imagination and Objectivity. In: Knowing Mothers. Studies in the Psychosocial Series. Palgrave Macmillan, London. https://doi.org/10.1057/9781137481238_3

Text outputs: Vignettes

We offer here a composite and anonymised vignette from an ethnographic observation of a supervision meeting, as a further elaboration of this idea. At GIDS, supervision meetings are spaces where clinicians can think about the young people in their care, discuss treatment plans with one another, and talk about the ways the pressures of the clinical work may be affecting them and their work with young people:

> In the meeting, clinicians described working with a young person and her family who were insistent that, if puberty blockers were not prescribed soon, the young person would commit suicide – tragically, this can be a feature of this work. The young person described experiencing gender dysphoria from early childhood and experiencing puberty as 'wrong'. The clinicians said they struggled to maintain GIDS's protocol, which required several more assessments before a referral could be made to the endocrinology service, although they did maintain it. In the penultimate assessment session, they discussed with the child and family the practicalities of puberty suppression – the pros and cons, the side effects, and so on. The next session, when a referral would have been made, the young person announced she was 'de-transitioning'. As the clinician described it, '*She felt she had understood her gender dysphoria within the context of misogyny. She wanted to escape from the pressure of being female. She said she avoids reading too much about detransition, because she supports trans rights; and she values the time she has lived as male. She told us about how she likes to be loud and opinionated, to share her thoughts, and this seemed more acceptable to do when living as a boy. She said she now has the confidence to be a loud woman.*' The patient did not turn up for subsequent appointments.

Citation: Baraitser L, Anucha K, Catty J et al. (Un)timely care: findings from the Waiting Times project [version 1; peer review: awaiting peer review]. Wellcome Open Res 2024, 9:490 (https://doi.org/10.12688/wellcomeopenres.22556.1)

Text outputs: Collective or historical narratives

THE BASQUE REFUGEE CHILDREN IN WICKHAM MARKET, 1938-1939

Edward Packard (edward@basquechildren.org)

This article was originally written in 2018 for the Wickham Market Area Archive Centre for their publication on the Workhouse – copies can be purchased via the WMAAC website. A report on the eightieth anniversary event at Wickham Market is available here.

In early 1938 the decommissioned Plomesgate Union workhouse became a place of sanctuary for nearly one hundred children from the Basque region of Spain. These children, or *niños*, were part of an evacuation of 4,000 child refugees from the Spanish Civil War, who came to Britain in May 1937 in the aftermath of the bombing of Guernica. Groups of the children were then sent to 'colonies' all over the country, including in Suffolk. The British government refused to provide any financial assistance, so the *niños* found themselves almost entirely dependent on the care and support provided by local individuals and organisations.

When the children arrived at the Wickham Market workhouse, they had spent several months living in the relatively luxurious Georgian mansion at Wherstead Park and only sixteen of the original hundred children had returned to Spain. Chlöe Vulliamy, the country coroner's daughter, was the colony's secretary, and cared deeply about the plight of the Spanish people. She resisted efforts to repatriate the *niños* back to Spain if she had evidence – including often heart-breaking letters from parents – that they would face misery or starvation if they returned.

With so many children to care for, and no government support, fundraising was an urgent matter. The children toured the region in costume, putting on concerts of their national songs and dances. Some of the boys played football matches against Suffolk teams. Local people were encouraged to 'adopt' a child – this involved subscribing ten shillings per week (about £30 in today's money). The government had made it a condition of the children's stay that those looking after them had to guarantee this sum per child. Besides money, local people also donated toys and furniture. The Ipswich Industrial Co-operative Society was an important contributor to the children's welfare: it helped with fundraising, as well as providing free bread and arranging occasional trips for the *niños*.

The memory of the Basque children's stay at Wickham Market is still vivid amongst local people, but not all agree about their friendliness or behaviour. Some say that there were frequent fights with the village boys; '...the place was wrecked'; '...they got on the roof and stripped the slates off'; '...they covered the walls inside with graffiti'. On the other hand, some remember them as very colourful and artistic. Their national dress was brilliant and they sometimes gave shows in the village. They roller-skated in Chapel Lane and executed elaborate dancing figures. They painted attractive murals on the walls of their rooms. One Chapel Lane lady gave them apples from her garden and they would sit in her front garden eating them and causing no trouble at all.

Chlöe Vulliamy suggested that the Wickham Market colony did not receive much interest from the locals there, and that the children missed Wherstead Park's proximity to the attractions of Ipswich. The *niños* did maintain the *paseo*, or evening walk, of their home country and could be seen promenading, arm-in-arm, around the village on fine evenings.

Some of the children who came to Wickham Market have shared their memories in the book *Recuerdos: Basque children refugees in Great Britain,* edited by Natalia Benjamin (Basque Children of '37 Association UK, 2007).

Maria Dolores Barajuán Fernandez, recalling the move to Wickham Market from Wherstead, remembered 'The change was terrible' and 'The feeling of neglect was overwhelming' at the workhouse.

Paco Robles Hernándo described the Plomesgate workhouse as 'truly ancient' and stated: 'I disliked that colony because we suffered from scabies, which had been brought in by some children who came from a different colony, and moreover it was infested with rats.'

His sister Maria described the colony as 'somewhat Dickensian' but not all bad:

'My memories of that colony are always of hot summer days, when we would walk to the river and spend the whole afternoon swimming. The colony had a number of outhouses and often some of the bigger girls would be in one of these outbuildings curling each others' hair with hot curling tongs. I would look on fascinated at the transformation taking place.'

Maria thinks that she received her first letters from her mother while at Wickham Market - at that time her father was a prisoner of war in Spain.

During 1939, the children gradually left Wickham Market: they were either sent to other Basque 'colonies' throughout Britain, or they returned to Spain. Six children who left the workhouse in April 1939 were given a lively and loud farewell at 8 a.m. in the morning by the remaining *niños* – with the noise awakening some of the villagers!

Quotations from *Recuerdos* used with grateful permission from BCA'37: The Association for the UK Basque Children.

Citation: Packard, Edward (2018) The Basque Refugee Children in Wickham Market, 1938-1939. Available at: https://www.basquechildren.org/-/docs/colonies/wickhammarket#:~:text=Edward%20Packard%20(edward%40basquechildren.org)&text=These%20children%2C%20or%20ni%C3%B1os%2C%20were,the%20country%2C%20including%20in%20Suffolk.

Creative outputs: Artwork

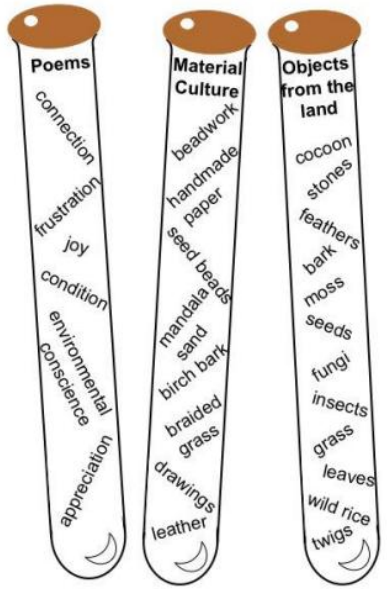

Figure 5. The contents and three main themes emerged from the test tube art installation.

Figure 6. The completed vial installation with test tubes filled with different materials representing the participants' connections and values for the land.

Citation: Zurba, Melanie and Friesen, Holly (2014). Finding Common Ground through Creativity: Exploring Indigenous, settler and Métis values and connection to the land. *The International Journal of Conflict and Reconciliation,* 2 (1), pp. 1-34.

Some final thoughts

- To what extent does qualitative research rely on the individual over the collective? Can procedures/policy/guidance encourage collective analysis/stories, or is this too limiting?
- Limiting quotations or certain types of variables/characteristics of individuals needs careful consideration in context of the study – this will always be best judged by experts in the study/topic
- Data becomes less sensitive over time – and detail becomes valuable to historians in future. Can/should secure qualitative data allow staged publishing of sensitive data?
- This does not encompass additional considerations for research with indigenous/non-Western groups (community-based research)
  - Ownership and access is particularly important
  - Data can become part of the group's living memory
  - Epistemological questions over "truth" in data
- Any other examples of outputs very welcome!

UK Data Service

Questions?

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